PLYMOUTH MARJON UNIVERSITY

AIC Experience The Difference 2024

# Programme Brief

## BA (Hons) Early Childhood Education and Care

### Important Note

All students must read this programme brief carefully before the commencement of the academic programme at AIC Campus. It is assumed that every student will read the contents below since they are important for the study programme at AIC Campus.

### Programme Duration

**1 year**

### Awarding Body

**Plymouth Marjon University (University of St Mark & St John), Plymouth UK**

### Final Award Title

**BA (Hons)**

### Programme Title

**Early Childhood Education and Care**

### Programme Objective

AIC Campus offers Higher Education in partnership with Plymouth Marjon University, UK. The BA (Hons) Early Childhood Education and Care programme aims to provide an academically challenging and intellectually rigorous course of learning that helps students develop the skills and competencies required to gain employment and commence a career within the early years workforce, as well as preparing them for future study through initial teacher training either in early years or primary education. In tandem with this, the programme aims to instill a lifelong love of learning, and an attitude of resilience and determination in the fields of both academic study and professional employment.

### Programme Overview

The BA (Hons) Early Childhood Education and Care degree provides students who are interested in becoming early years educators, early years teachers or working in other sectors supporting young children, an opportunity to gain a critical insight into early childhood care and education as well as broader issues of learning, teaching and childhood. A work-based learning module provides an important link to practice, supporting students to develop their skills in preparation for working in the sector in the future. This programme is a one-year full time level six programme for students who already have a suitable level five qualification. This level 6 programme allows students to explore topics related to quality and leadership in the early years and to consider critical approaches to pedagogy, helping them to shape their own views on effective pedagogy and practice.



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Additionally, this year allows students to undertake a self-directed honours level project on a topic of their choosing. Throughout the programme, students have opportunity to direct their studies in support of their specific interests and career aspirations through options available in response to assessment tasks within specific modules. Alongside the content-focussed learning sits wider and more diffuse aspects of learning, which are enhanced through the approach to pedagogy and assessment; among other things, this learning includes development of digital competence, enhanced oral and written communication skills, the ability to work collaboratively, and seek creative solutions.

## Class Schedule

- **Weekend Programme**

**Saturday:**

**Session 01:** 1:00 PM to 4:00 PM

**Session 02:** 4:30 PM to 7:30 PM

- **Sunday:**

**Extra Session (if required):** Between 1:00 PM to 8:00 PM

***Special Note**

- A combination of online hybrid and physical classes will be conducted.
- Once a month, students are expected to attend at least one physical class.
- Students are expected to take part in physical workshops and other learning sessions.
- Class times could slightly change from above based on the availability of the lecturer and the classrooms.
- Cover up classes will be arranged for any cancelled classes due to various reasons.

## Assessments and Evaluations

Assessment on the programme offers breadth, depth and challenge. Module assessment is designed to engage a range of skills, with students undertaking assignments that are theoretical or academic, reflective, or practical in nature. Assessment may be independent or collaborative, but there is a rich variety in each year to ensure students develop holistically throughout the programme, as well as engaging fully in their academic learning. Many of the module assignments give students an opportunity to apply their knowledge in real-world contexts, mainly through their work-based practice.

Whilst assessment of learning is integral to students' progression through the programme, assessment for learning is equally important. We therefore support students through constructive and positive feedback and through formative assessment opportunities. Assessment is further supported dialogically, in group sessions as well as in tutorials, so that students feel confident about assessment, understand its purpose, and know how to proactively engage in order to succeed. The feedback we provide based on student submissions is integral to supporting students development, and there is an expectation that students make good use of their feedback, engaging with support services to help as necessary, and to feed forward their feedback for the attention of markers in subsequent assignments.



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- **Typical Assessment Methods:** could include CPD Plan, Education Project, Essay, Ethical Approval Application, Leaflet, Portfolio, Presentation, and Project.

## University Recognition

- Plymouth Marjon University is a public university located in Plymouth, England.
- Plymouth Marjon University is fully recognized by UK government.
- Fully recognized by OfS (Office for Students) the independent university recognition body in the UK.
- Recognized by University Grants Commission (UGC), Sri Lanka.
- Listed in the World Higher Education Database (WHED) of International Association of Universities (IAU).
- Listed in the Commonwealth Universities Yearbook.

## University Ranking:

Plymouth Marjon University is ranked as follows:

- Top 5 in the UK for Career Prospects - WhatUni Student Choice Awards 2024
- No. 3 in England for Student Satisfaction - Complete University Guide 2025
- Top 5 in the UK for Lecturers and Teaching Quality- WhatUni Student Choice Awards 2024
- Rated Joint 1st of UK Universities for Academic Support- National Student Survey 2024
- No. 3 University in England for Social Inclusion- Good University Guide 2024
- No.1 in UK for Assessment- Postgraduate Taught Experience Survey 2023
- No. 3 University in the UK for "How good are teaching staff at explaining things?" -National Student Survey 2023
- Top 5 in England for Teaching Quality- Good University Guide 2024
- Rated 2nd of UK Universities for Student Voice- National Student Survey 2024

## Admission Criteria

**Admission Academic:**

- Successful completion of the AIC Advanced Diploma in Early Childhood Education.
- Successful completion of a Level 5 or above qualification in Education or Early Childhood Education (such as an Advanced Diploma or HND) that meets the university's entry requirements.

**English Language requirement:**

- A grade of C or above in GCSE English.
- The medium of instruction for the most recent qualification should be English.
- Successful completion of the AIC English Language Proficiency interview.



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## List of Documents for Admission

- Academic CV
- AIC Application
- PMU Application
- O/L Certificate
- A/L Certificate or level 3 qualification
- University/Professional Certificates and Transcripts of Level 5 or above qualification in ECE/Education
- Proof of English Language Proficiency
- Copy of passport (or any other identification in English)
- Two Passport-Size Photographs and a softcopy
- Initial Payment Confirmation
- Signed Programme Brief
- Student Admission Agreement

## Programme Delivery Mode

- Online Live Delivery: Live and recorded lectures are delivered via Microsoft Teams.
- AIC Microsoft Teams: Used for examinations and assignment submissions, in parallel with classroom delivery.
- Monthly Face-to-Face Classes: Held once a month at the AIC Campus Colombo flagship campus.
- Workshops and Seminars: Students are required to participate in workshops and seminars conducted by AIC Campus (Colombo).
- Placement Visits/Practical/School-Based Activities: Students must inform their choice of internship location and obtain prior approval from AIC Campus.

## List of Subjects

| Module Code | Module Title | Credits |
|---|---|---|
| PREHP1 | Education Project | 40 |
| CPRH51 | Work based Learning in Early Childhood Education and Care 3 | 20 |
| SEDH53 | Rethinking Education through Critical Pedagogy | 20 |
| CPRH52 | Leadership and Quality in the Early Years | 20 |
| PREH04 | Supporting Children and Young People | 20 |
| | Total | 120 |



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## Pathway to Further Education and Career Opportunities

Many students may choose to enter the early years workforce as early years educators and upon successful completion of the programme and they will be well placed to develop their leadership roles and positions within the sector. It is understood, that from this place of employment, many choose to engage with additional study to develop themselves and their practice. In addition to opportunities for qualification as Early Years Teachers through postgraduate study, graduates may also wish to consider appropriate employment opportunities as detailed below:

- Non-educational graduate careers
- Youth work
- Social work
- Play Therapy
- Self-employed route as a Registered Childminder
- Self-employed route establishing an early years setting
- Education – ancillary staff (teaching assistants, school administrators)
- Local government
- Graduate opportunities in business
- Preschool Teacher
- Elementary School Teacher
- Childcare Center Director
- Home-Based Service Provider
- Family Support Specialist
- Consultant
- Researcher

## Compulsory materials for students to refer before commencement of their programme

1. **AIC student handbook**
2. **Academic policies and procedures of AIC** (Refer Video - https://youtu.be/3koxHNfLGMg)

- Internal Verification Policy - https://www.aicedu.lk/academic-progression/policy/Internal-Verification-Policy.pdf
- Assessment Policy - https://www.aicedu.lk/academic-progression/policy/Assessment-Policy.pdf
- Learner Recruitment, Registration and Certification Policy -https://www.aicedu.lk/academic-progression/policy/Learner-Recruitment-Registration-and-Certification-Policy.pdf
- Special Consideration and Reasonable Adjustment Policy- https://www.aicedu.lk/academic-progression/policy/Special-Consideration-and-Reasonable-Adjustment-Policy.pdf
- Equal Opportunity Policy - https://www.aicedu.lk/academic-progression/policy/Equal-Opportunity-Policy.pdf
- Malpractice and Maladministration Policy - https://www.aicedu.lk/academic-progression/policy/Malpractice-and-Maladministration-Policy.pdf



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- Student Appeal and Complaint Policy - https://www.aicedu.lk/academic-progression/policy/Student-Appeal-and-Complaint-Policy.pdf
- Risk Assessment and Health and Safety Policy - https://www.aicedu.lk/academic-progression/policy/Risk-Assessment-and-Health-and-Safety-Policy.pdf
- Conflict of Interest Policy - https://www.aicedu.lk/academic-progression/policy/Learner-Support-Policy.pdf
- Learner Support Policy - https://www.aicedu.lk/academic-progression/policy/Learner-Support-Policy.pdf
- Safeguarding Learners Policy - https://www.aicedu.lk/academic-progression/policy/Safeguarding-Learners-Policy.pdf
- Contingency and Adverse Effects Policy - https://www.aicedu.lk/academic-progression/policy/Contingency-and-Adverse-Effects-Policy.pdf

3. **Important Forms, (Refer video-** https://youtu.be/3koxHNfLGMg**)**
   - Academic Advising Form - https://www.aicedu.lk/academic-progression/forms/AIC-Academic-Advising-Form.pdf
   - College Withdrawal Form - https://www.aicedu.lk/academic-progression/forms/AIC-College-Withdrawal-Form.pdf
   - Enrolment Form - https://www.aicedu.lk/academic-progression/forms/AIC-Application-Form.pdf
   - Graduation Application Form - https://www.aicedu.lk/academic-progression/forms/AIC-Graduation-Application-Form.pdf
   - Inter Programme Change Form - https://www.aicedu.lk/academic-progression/forms/AIC-Program-Change-Form.pdf
4. **Suggestions / Compliments / Feedback Form-** https://www.aicedu.lk/suggestions-compliments-feedback-form.php
5. **MS Teams virtual classroom system –** https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365/microsoft-teams/download-app
   https://youtu.be/aO9LE6ZKnUM

I hereby declare that I have read and understood and agree to comply the above content in my specified programme at AIC Campus.

| E.Kamsitha | E.Ramsitha | 23/05/2026 |
|---|---|---|
| Student Name | Signature | Date |